

BUSINESS WORKFLOW DATA COLLECTION FORM

AI Business Automation — Customer Discovery

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Purpose: Use this during company calls/visits to understand real repetitive workflows. The goal is to discover a problem worth solving — not to force AI into a process.

A. COMPANY INFORMATION

Field	Information
Company name	
Industry	
Location	
Contact person / role	
Email / phone	
Employees (approx.)	
Date	
Contact method	Email / LinkedIn / call / visit / referral

B. DISCOVER THE PAIN

Ask about what employees actually do. Don't start by asking what they want automated.

- Which tasks do employees repeat every day on a computer?
- Which task takes the most time?
- Which task is boring, repetitive or frustrating?
- Where do delays or mistakes usually happen?
- Which task would you most like to stop doing manually?
- What information is repeatedly copied, pasted, checked or re-entered?

C. WORKFLOW MAP

Field	Record
Workflow / process	
Business trigger	What starts it?
Input	Email / PDF / order / form / message / spreadsheet / etc.
Step 1	
Step 2	
Step 3	
Step 4	

Step 5+	
Final outcome	What should happen when complete?

D. WORKLOAD & COST

Metric	Information
Frequency	Per hour / day / week / month
Cases per day	
People involved	
Minutes per case	
Total employee hours/day	
Peak periods	
Current cost / impact	If known

E. TOOLS & SYSTEMS

■ Email (Gmail / Outlook / other)

■ Excel / Google Sheets

■ ERP (SAP / Tally / other)

■ CRM

■ Helpdesk / ticketing

■ Accounting software

■ WhatsApp / messaging

■ Internal/custom software

■ Other: _____

Systems used: _____

Where is data copied between systems? _____

F. AUTOMATION POTENTIAL

Capability	Potential
Read / understand input	■ Yes ■ No
Extract information	■ Yes ■ No
Classify / categorize	■ Yes ■ No
Check rules / eligibility	■ Yes ■ No
Draft response	■ Yes ■ No
Update system	■ Yes ■ No
Route to employee	■ Yes ■ No
Execute final action	■ Yes ■ No — review/approval

G. HUMAN CONTROL & RISK

Principle: AI handles repetitive work; humans remain responsible for judgment and important decisions.

Area	Notes
Low-risk steps	
Human review steps	
Approval-required steps	
Sensitive information involved?	■ No ■ Yes — don't record private data
Financial/customer-impacting action?	■ No ■ Yes — approval required
What happens when AI is uncertain?	

H. OPPORTUNITY SCORE

Factor	Score
Frequency (1–5)	
Time consumed (1–5)	
Business impact (1–5)	
Error/delay cost (1–5)	
Automation feasibility (1–5)	
Repeatability across companies (1–5)	
Risk difficulty (1–5; lower is easier)	
TOTAL / NOTES	

I. FOLLOW-UP & DECISION

■ Open to second conversation ■ Workflow observation possible ■ Non-sensitive example possible ■ Potential pilot ■
Not a fit

Best next step: _____

Our hypothesis: _____

Should we build this? ■ YES ■ MAYBE ■ NO

Why? _____

Potential MVP: _____

J. DATA SAFETY

Do not collect passwords, API keys, confidential customer information, personal financial information, or other unnecessary sensitive data. Ask permission before viewing internal systems/documents. Record the workflow and business problem rather than private customer data.